

Multiple cultures

Your baby will live in a multicultural society, affecting education and friendships. There's a strong chance a child will be cared for by someone from another culture at some point.

THE STATISTICS

Changing family life

The statistics below reveal how family life has changed over decades.

- In the US, 64 percent of moms with children under the age of six work; in the UK, 55 percent of mothers of children under five work (compared with around 25 percent in 1975).
- About 25 percent of children under five with working moms are cared for full-time by dad and 30 percent of working parents share child care.
- About 25 percent of married moms stay at home full time with the children.
- The number of single-parent families has been roughly stable since 2010, in which 27 percent of children lived with one parent and no other adult in the household. Nearly 80 percent of single-parent homes are headed by single mothers.
- In 2017, between 2 and 3.7 million children had an LGBTQ parent.

THE GENDER GAP

Boys versus girls Historically, about 106 boys have been born for every 100 girls—believed to be nature's way of compensating for the fact that males are more likely to be killed in conflicts. But ratios are changing. One factor may be increased stress (women under stress produce more girls than boys).

Research studies in the US and Sweden have also discovered that certain chemical pollutants in the environment can impact the human sex ratio at birth of babies..